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Title:

The Chess Piece Piece

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The Chess Piece Piece

Characters:
The King- A beleaguered ruler
The Bishop- A pretentious clergyman
The Pawns- Nearly identical foot soldiers
The Knight- A horse?
The Rook- A building?
The Queen- A vicious warrior

[The King surveys the battlefield with his advisor, the Bishop, at his side.]

King: It is a dark day for the chess board. Tensions between the kingdoms of Black and White are at an all time high. War approaches. The battle lines have been drawn. And then battle lines have been drawn that criss-cross those first battle lines so that we can have nice, neat squares. Bishop!

Bishop: Yes, my king?

King: How go the preparations?

Bishop: Oh most excellently, your highness. The Holy Order of the White Kingdom has assembled-

King: Wait. Stop.

Bishop: Sire?

King: The Holy Order of the White Kingdom? Doesn't that sound a little…? I mean. Yikes.

Bishop: But your highness, for millennia, this has always been the White Kingdom.

King: I mean, sure, but I always thought that was, like, a uniform thing.

Bishop: And as your majesty's bishop, I lead the Holy Order-

King: Church. Just say church.

Bishop: I lead the *church* of the Kingdom of White. In order to preserve the values and traditions of-

King: It's just- Are we sure about the name?

Bishop: Sire, don't lose faith! Your people need you. And the White people are a proud people.

King: Stop saying it like that! You know what? *The* Kingdom. Just say *The* Kingdom. We'll win the war, then we'll workshop the name.

Bishop: Yes, your majesty.

King: Now, where is my army?

Bishop: Here they come, your majesty. The finest foot soldiers in the kingdom.

[The Pawns enter. They are short, coarse, and nearly identical to one another.]

Pawn A: Hello.

Pawn B: Hello.

Pawn C: Hello.

Pawn D: Hello.

Pawn E: Hello.

Pawn F: Hello.

Pawn G: Hello.

Pawn H: Hello.

Bishop: How dare you, men! This is his highness, The King, Lord and Protector of the realm! You must address him as "Your Majesty."

Pawn A: Oh! Sorry, your majesty.

Pawn B: Sorry, your majesty.

Pawn C: Sorry, your majesty.

Pawn D: Sorry, your majesty.

Pawn E: Sorry, your majesty.

Pawn F: Sorry, your majesty.

Pawn G: Sorry, your majesty.

Pawn H: Sorry, your maj-

King: That's quite alright! Thank you. *(Aside)* Bishop, who are these strange men?

Bishops: Pawns, your majesty.

King: Pawns?

Bishop: Peasants, your majesty. Farm folk.

King: Desperate times, I suppose. And they're… twins? *(Quickly counting them)* Octuplets?

Pawn C: Yes, your majesty.

Pawn D: Our mother was in a lot of pain.

Pawn E: Cracked her open like an egg, it did.

King: I can imagine. Well, let's see how you are on the field of battle. You there! Let's see you march.

Pawn G: Aye, sir!

[Pawn G marches a single step forward.]

King: Is that all?

Pawn G: Aye, sir.

King: You only moved one step forward.

Pawn G: Aye, sir.

King: Could you take another step?

Pawn G: I don't think I can, your majesty. I think I need to stop and process the step I just took. It was honestly a lot for me to handle.

King: Then, you there! You try marching.

Pawn H: I can't, your majesty.

King: Why not?

Pawn H: Well, he's right in front of me, sire.

Pawn G: I am right in front of him, sire. On account of the step I took.

Pawn H: Can't march forward. He's in the way.

King: Then step *around* him.

Pawn H: *(mispronouncing)* A-rooned?

King: Around.

Pawn H: A-ronned?

King: Around! Step around him!

Pawn H: I'm sorry, your majesty, I don't know the word! I haven't done any book learning.

King: Then take a step backward!

Pawn H: Again, you're going to need to simplify the vocabulary.

King: Forget it! Bishop, we need someone to train these men.

Bishop: Of course, your majesty. I have acquired the services of the finest knight in the kingdom.

King: Thank goodness for that.

Bishop: Ah, here he is now.

[The Knight appears. He is a horse.]

Knight: *(Neighs.)*

[The King, lost for words, stares at the Knight. He slowly turns his head toward the Bishop.]

King: Bishop?

Bishop: Yes, your majesty?

King: That is a horse.

Bishop: Yes, your majesty.

King: I asked for a knight?

Bishop: Correct.

King: And that's a horse.

Bishop: Right.

Knight: *(Huffs in affirmation.)*

King: Does the horse have a knighthood?

Bishop: He does, your highness. He was awarded a knighthood for bravery in battle.

King: Bravery in battle?

Knight: *(Whinnies.)*

King: Does he… does he use a sword then? A lance? Does he just kick people?

Bishop: He jumps.

King: He jumps?

[The Knight whinnies and does a little jump.]

Pawn B: Wow. Wish I could do that.

King: I can't go into battle like this! Isn't there anyone else?

Bishop: Well, there is the Rook.

King: Who is that? What does that mean?

Bishop: I believe it comes from the Persian "rukh," meaning chariot, but-

King: A charioteer! Wonderful, just like the Romans. Where is he?

Bishop: Well-

[The Rook is a building. He stands straight, still, and silent.]

Rook: …

King: Oh my god, when did that castle get there?!

Bishop: That would be the Rook, your majesty.

King: This *building* is the Rook? My charioteer is a brick building?

Rook: …

King: Does it… move?

[The Rook silently steps from side to side.]

Bishop: You can hide behind it if you like.

King: I just might.

Knight: *[Neighs.]*

Bishop: What's that? Oh! I believe her majesty the Queen is approaching.

King: The Queen? *(Sarcastically)* Oh, that's just what I need.

Queen: Yoo-hoo!

King: Dearest? What are you doing here?

Queen: I'm here for the battle!

King: But sweetheart it isn't safe!

Queen: Not safe for them. I'm gonna mess some people up.

King: Do you have any combat experience?

Queen: Who cares? I have the itch. The warrior fever. I'm ready to *kill*.

King: What? Wouldn't you rather stay in the Rook?

Queen: And miss all the fun? The glory? I don't think so! I'm out for blood. Anywhere on the board, I will be there! I am a one-woman *slaughter*. Get the sausage casings, boys- I am turning this board into a meat grinder!

Bishop: Your majesty, the time for battle is fast approaching!

King: You're right. Men… Honey… This is the moment we've prepared for. Is everyone ready?

Pawn A: How are we paying for this war? It ain't coming out of our taxes, is it?

King: Sorry?

Pawn A: I just want to know who's picking up the check for all this.

Pawn B: It's not about the check, mate.

King: It is all about the checkmate!

Pawn A: *(Whispering aside)* Someone's touchy.

Knight: *(Huffs conspiratorially)*

Pawn F: I've got a question!

King: Fine. What is it?

Pawn F: If I march all the way over there, what do I get?

King: If you march all the way to the enemy base?

Pawn F: Yeah, what do I get?

King: What do you want?

Pawn F: Could I get a new job?

King: A promotion? Certainly, I could make you a knight or a bishop-

Pawn F: Would you marry me?

King: What?

Pawn F: I want to be a queen. I get to the other side, will you marry me?

King: I already have a queen!

Queen: I don't mind!

Pawn F: Besides, she might die.

Queen: That's true, dearest, I might die.

King: Then… sure. I guess. But only if you get all the way over there! Now, hush, I can see the enemy assembling.

[The King looks through a spyglass across the field. He gasps.]

Bishop: What is it, sire?

King: The enemy appears to be… circles.

Bishop: Circles, your highness?

King: Yes, circles. Giant disks. Men, do you know what this means?

Knight: *(Whinnies confusedly)*

King: They've decided to play checkers instead! We're safe. We can all go home.

Queen: Aww, I wanted to frenzy…

King: Bishop! Let us return to the castle for a feast.

Bishop: Yes, your highness. Men! Follow me!

[All exit except the two pawns, still caught in a stalemate.]

Pawn G: Move! I am trying to go to the castle.

Pawn H: You're the one in the way, you move.

Pawn G: You move.

Pawn H: You move!

Pawn G: You move!

Pawn H: You move!

[THE END.]